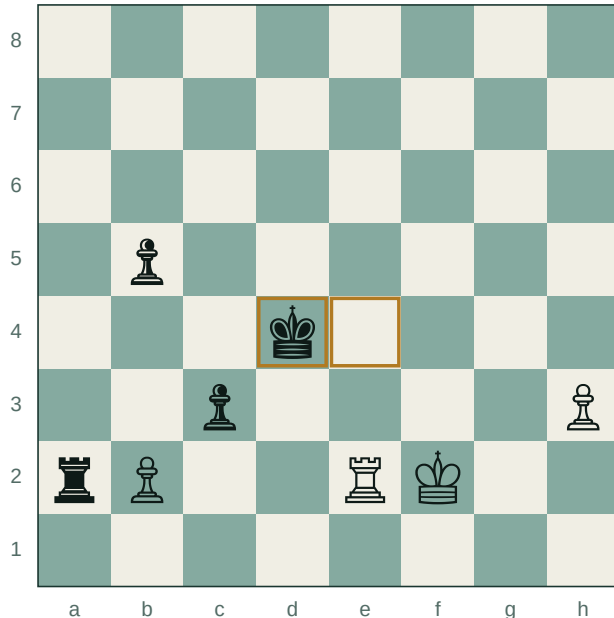


Discovered attacks: White, move 50

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 49...Kd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

50. bxc3+ Kxc3 51. Rxa2

50.bxc3+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on e2 attacks the rook on a2. Recorded reply: **50...Kxc3**.

51.Rxa2 The rook captures the rook on a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on d4. Geometrically undefended: rook on a2. Check for tactical protection.